QA Guidelines – WhatsApp Governance

Objective

Ensure all interactions strictly comply with:

- Script adherence
- Regulatory requirements
- Channel limitations

WhatsApp is a communication-only channel and not an authorized environment for validation, decision-making, or compliance processing.

Scope

Applies to Customer Service, Fraud Prevention, and Operations personnel authorized to use the WhatsApp Business channel.

WhatsApp is strictly a communication-only channel and is not authorized for:

- Complaint or dispute handling
- Transaction-specific processing or confirmation
- Fraud confirmation or investigative communication
- Compliance decision-making or validation

All such activities must be redirected to the appropriate authorized channels or systems.

WhatsApp may be used to communicate regarding potential fraud; however, no confirmation, denial, or discussion of investigative outcomes is permitted.

Roles & Responsibilities

Customer Service

- Communication and routing only
- Must follow approved scripts without deviation
- Responsible for escalation and redirection

Fraud Prevention

- Risk identification and escalation only
- No direct customer communication via WhatsApp for investigative matters

Operations

- Documentation transfer and workflow support
- No decision-making or validation

Compliance / Chronos

- Sole authority for validation, approval, and regulatory decisions
- All compliance processing occurs outside WhatsApp

QA Evaluation Principles

- WhatsApp = communication only
- Zero tolerance for:
  - Validation
  - Decision-making
  - Improvisation - Any deviation from approved scripts, including paraphrasing, summarizing, or interpretation, is considered a violation.

Procedural Risk Framework – WhatsApp QA

Risk Dimensions (What QA Must Evaluate)

Each interaction must be assessed across **4 core risk pillars**:

1. **Regulatory Risk**
   Breach of compliance obligations (SAR exposure, privacy violations, UDAAP)
2. **Operational Risk**
   Failure to follow the defined process (routing, escalation, documentation handling)
3. **Conduct Risk**
   Agent behavior that could mislead, imply decisions, or create expectations
4. **Data Protection Risk**
   Improper handling of sensitive or personal information

Risk Severity Levels

Level	Definition	Impact
Low	Minor deviation, no regulatory exposure	Coaching
Moderate	Process failure with potential downstream impact	Corrective action
High	Clear policy breach, customer impact	Escalation required
Critical	Regulatory violation or SAR/privacy exposure	Immediate action + reporting

Procedural Risk Matrix (Core Controls)

Control Area	Risk Trigger	Risk Type	Severity
Script adherence	Any deviation from the approved script	Conduct / Regulatory	High
Identity validation	Agent confirms identity	Regulatory / Data	**Critical**
Transaction status	Agent confirms or implies the outcome	Regulatory / Conduct	**Critical**
Document handling	Agent evaluates or comments on docs	Regulatory	High
Dispute handling	Not redirected	Operational / Regulatory	High
Privacy request	Not escalated	Data Protection	**Critical**
SAR exposure	Any reference or hint	Regulatory	**Critical**
Improvisation	Agent paraphrases or adds interpretation	Conduct	High
Timeline expectations	The agent gives unofficial timing	Conduct	Moderate
Escalation failure	No routing to Chronos	Operational	High

QA Heat Map (Enforcement Tool)

Heat Map Grid

Frequency	Low Impact	Medium Impact	High Impact	Critical Impact
Low Frequency	Monitor	Monitor	Escalate	Escalate
Medium Frequency	Coach	Correct	Escalate	**Immediate Action**
High Frequency	Correct	Escalate	**Immediate Action**	**Systemic Failure**

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How QA Should Use It

Step 1: Identify the Breach

- Map issue to control area (e.g., "status confirmation")

Step 2: Assign Severity

- Use matrix above (e.g., → Critical)

Step 3: Assess Frequency

- One-off vs repeated vs systemic

Step 4: Place in Heat Map

Example:

- Agent confirms transaction status
  → Critical + Medium frequency
  → **Immediate Action required**

QA must document:

- Control breach
- Risk type
- Severity level
- Justification for classification

QA Escalation Triggers (Non-Negotiable)

Immediate escalation if ANY of the following occur:

- Confirmation or implication of transaction outcome
- Identity validation or acknowledgment
- SAR reference (direct or indirect)
- Privacy request handled in chat
- Agent processes or evaluates documents
- Any confirmation, denial, or discussion of potential fraud outcomes

Implicit Violations (Interpretation Required)

The following examples are considered violations even if not explicitly stated:

- "Looks good" → considered validation
- "It should be approved" → implied transaction confirmation
- "Your transaction is under review" → potential investigative/SAR exposure
- Providing internal process explanations → over-disclosure

QA must evaluate intent vs. impact, not just explicit wording.

QA Maturity Layer

Beyond basic review:

Level 1 – Compliance Check

- Did the agent follow the script?

Level 2 – Risk Interpretation

- Did the agent imply something beyond the script?

Level 3 – Intent vs Impact

- Even if well-intended → did it create risk?

Level 4 – Pattern Detection

- Is this behavior recurring across agents?

Bottom Line for QA

If the interaction:

- **Explains internal processes → Risk**
- **Suggests → Risk**
- **Reassures → Risk**
- **Confirms → Violation**

QA Checklist (Audit Use)

1. Script Compliance

- Approved script used verbatim
- No rephrasing, shortening, or improvisation
- Mandatory disclosures included when applicable

2. Scope Adherence

- Interaction limited to communication and routing
- No operational, compliance, or decision actions performed

3. Prohibited Actions Check

- No identity verification performed
- No transaction status confirmed or implied
- No document evaluation or commentary
- No timelines or expectations provided outside the script
- No mention of SAR or internal processes

4. Escalation & Redirection
   - Disputes properly redirected
   - Privacy requests escalated to the correct channel
   - Suspicious activity escalated immediately
   - Documentation transferred to Chronos

5. Communication Quality
   - Clear, professional, and neutral tone
   - No misleading or suggestive language
   - No over-disclosure of internal processes

6. Data Handling & Security
   - No sensitive data processed within WhatsApp
   - Proper acknowledgment without validation
   - No request for prohibited information (OTP, passwords, etc.)

7. Closure Compliance
   - Interaction properly closed or redirected
   - No continued engagement after escalation when required

QA Checklist

Control Area	Requirement	Compliant (Y/N)	Risk Type	Severity	QA Comments
Script Compliance	Script used verbatim				
Script Compliance	No improvisation				
Scope	No complaints handled				
Scope	No transaction-specific discussion				
Prohibited Actions	No validation, approval, or decision-making actions performed				
Prohibited Actions	No approval/implied outcome				

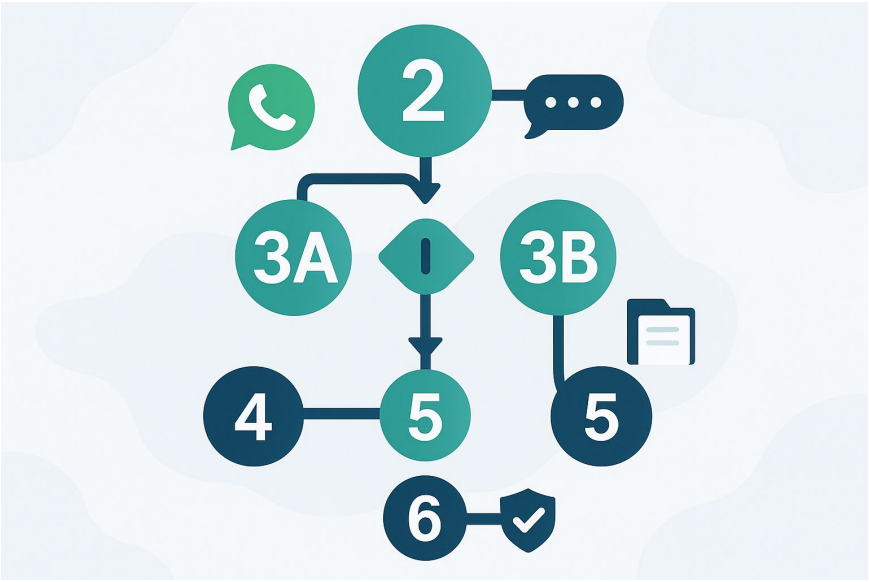
Control Area	Requirement	Compliant (Y/N)	Risk Type	Severity	QA Comments
Escalation	Proper redirection executed				
Data Handling	No sensitive processing				
Communication	No misleading language				
Closure	Proper closure/redirection				
Fraud Communication	No confirmation, denial, or discussion of fraud outcomes				

QA Outcome Classification

- **Compliant** → Fully aligned
- **Minor Deviation** → Non-material (tone/format only)
- **Major Violation** → Policy breach (validation, decision, improvisation) → Mandatory escalation and corrective action
- **Critical Breach** → Regulatory risk (SAR exposure, data misuse, unauthorized confirmation) → Immediate escalation to Compliance and incident documentation

WhatsApp Governance Flow

Step	Action	Control
1	Customer contacts via WhatsApp	Channel = Communication only
2	Customer Service responds (approved scripts)	No improvisation
3A	Within scope → Communicate only	No validation / no decisions
3B	Out of scope → Redirect / Escalate	Disputes / Privacy / Fraud / Transactions
4	Transfer information to Chronos	No processing in WhatsApp
5	Compliance reviews & decides	Validation / Approval
6	QA reviews interaction	Risk + compliance assessment



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